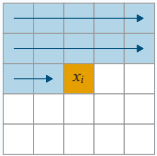
density access ● exact likelihood

(a) PixelCNN

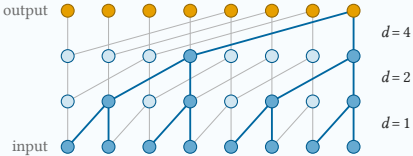


x_i

$\mathbf{x}_{<i}$ visible to the kernel (raster order)

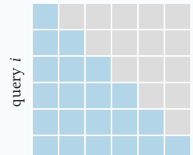
masked

(b) WaveNet



receptive field doubles per layer;
each output sees only past samples

(c) GPT



mask $j \le i$: all N conditionals in one parallel pass; sampling remains sequential with a KV cache